



IFRC
AA for Agriculture and
Food Security –
Voices from the Field

21 April 2025

Layered approach to evidence



- **Foundational level – Lessons Learned/After Action Reviews**
 - Quick, low costs, National Society owned – immediately feeds into the revised Early Action Protocol
- **Intermediate level – Rapid Reviews and Evaluations**
 - Focus on impact of AA, triangulation of lessons learned, identify trends, take time and resources – recommendations take time to feed into revisions of an Early Action Protocols
- **High level –process/procedure reviews – activations and non activation, pilot phase reviews of funding mechanisms**
 - Brings voices from the field via KIIs and FGD, makes DREF polices and procedures more effective and efficient

Lessons Learned



Facilitated by National Societies

Locally lead

Promotes ownership

Participative approach

Real time learning

Acknowledges contribution made by volunteers





In Mali, security challenges in the first activation led to changes in the revised EAP:

- *Integrate security management into an activation SOP*
- *Develop a communication plan for armed groups*
- *Recruit a security focal point*



In Nepal, lessons following activation floods sEAP led to:

- ***Harmonization of trigger statement and Early Action with the Municipal Early Action Framework***

A woman wearing a red vest with a white cross and the text "Cruz Roja" is sitting at a table, talking to a man wearing a red cap. She is holding a piece of paper. The background shows a concrete wall and a green pole.

In Honduras, challenges with timely transfer of cash to at-risk households:

- *Has led to the Honduran Red Cross to use 'Red Rose', a platform used to pre-register and facilitate cash transfers*

Ethiopia Drought 2024



- Anticipatory action done in end of 2024, focusing on Somali and Oromia zones, in Ethiopia implemented by ERCS with support from GRC and GFFO
- Anticipatory action activities:
 - Drought early warning messages
 - Unconditional cash (Residents in the Somali region received 11,300 Birr (~75 USD) – 24,835 household reached
 - Rehabilitation of water points – 27 water points fixed
 - Hygiene promotion awareness raising
 - Distribute fodder for animals – 100kg hay distributed to 3000 households
 - Vaccination of animals (and pre-positioning medicine) – 50,000 animals reached

Success Case Method



Based on a methodology developed by Robert Brinkerhoff in 2005 and identified by Selby Knudsen (Climate Centre Intern) as a viable methodology for AA

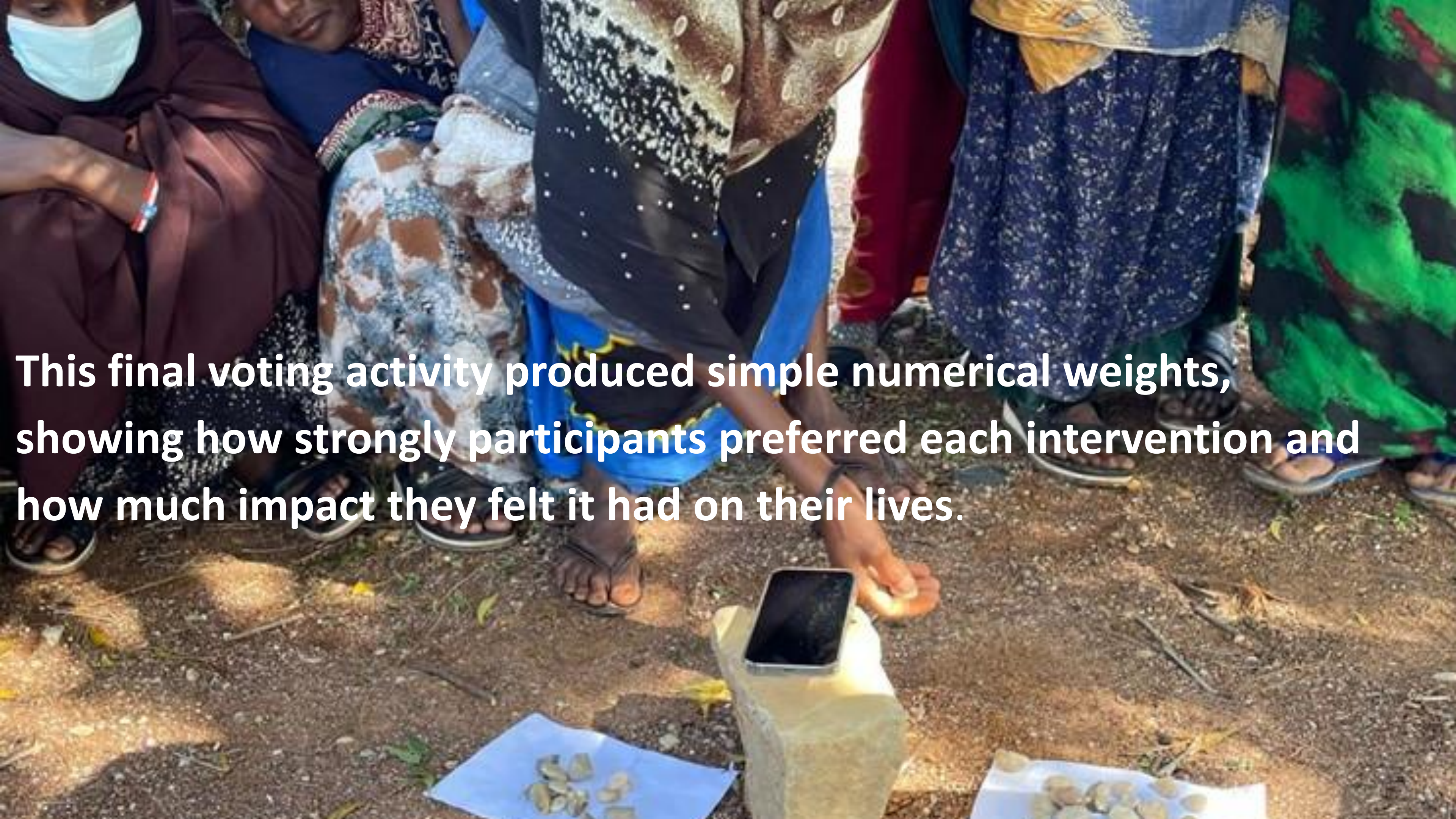
Success case method pairs quantitative survey results with qualitative insights to understand the factors that enabled or constrained positive outcomes from anticipatory actions

Success Case Method



Steps in the SCM methodology:

- Develop a theory of change for each early action
- Train enumerators (e.g. Ethiopian Red Cross volunteers) on how to conduct surveys; in local languages using Kobo
- Collect survey data (min.150 hh per intervention package): demographic and vulnerability information, along with indicators of outcome and impact
- Based on the theory of change and indicator results, identify what were the better and worse outcomes – the ‘success’ and ‘non success’ case
- Semi-structured interviews with households from both the better-outcome (“success case”) and worse-outcome (“non-success case”) groups.
- Results supplemented with Focus Group Discussions based on participatory impact assessment.
- Triangulated findings, enabling the identification of correlations between household characteristics and better or worse outcomes.

A group of people, mostly women, are gathered outdoors on a dirt ground. They are wearing colorful traditional clothing. In the foreground, a smartphone is placed on a small white block, with two blue papers nearby, each containing several small, light-colored stones. The text is overlaid on the image.

This final voting activity produced simple numerical weights, showing how strongly participants preferred each intervention and how much impact they felt it had on their lives.

Findings

Overall, the evaluation found:

Early warning messages reached communities unevenly but earlier receipt is strongly correlated with better outcomes;

Cash was primarily used to meet immediate needs. Only comparatively better-off households were able to make small productive investments;

Fodder was appreciated but insufficient in quantity;

Vaccination campaigns perceived as beneficial;

Waterpoint rehabilitation improved access to safer water, reduced travel time in some cases, but did not meet Sphere standards;

Hygiene promotion had limited reach; primary barrier to hygiene practices is access to soap, not knowledge.

Communities valued *cash* and *water* most highly



Recommendations: next EAP



Test **larger up-front or repeated assistance** packages to see if such packages enable preparedness or smooth consumption for a longer period;

Revise **cash expenditure** guidance to reflect the realities of slow-onset, long-duration droughts;

Distribute **fodder** to cover the full drought period;

Issue **community early warnings** as early as possible;

Pairing **WASH education** with ongoing provision of **essential items**; and

Ensuring **waterpoint rehabilitation** is based on strong technical due diligence and community input so that water is accessible, palatable and meets household needs year-round



Layered approach to learning



While impact evaluations provide rich findings, the learning cannot be quickly implemented

Highlights the value of localised 'lessons learned' in real time

Complemented by learning from other organisation's activations and evaluations



Next steps



Strengthening AA Evidence Workshop

4 – 7 May, Kathmandu Nepal

Supported by American Red Cross

Facilitated by American Red Cross, Red Cross Red Crescent Climate Centre,
German Red Cross

Targeting 20 National Red Cross Red Crescent Societies